Plan a Workshop

RE Task Description

Requirements workshops are an important technique for gathering and validating requirements through direct interaction with stakeholders. Their effectiveness depends on prior preparation, including analysis of relevant internal and external information sources, documentation of findings and assumptions, and clarification of open questions.

AI Approach

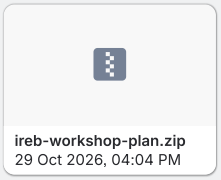
An AI-based approach supports workshop preparation by helping structure available information, identify relevant aspects, and highlight assumptions and open issues. It can provide a starting point for exploring a topic area and preparing more focused workshop discussions.

Conclusion

Applied to workshop preparation, the approach can improve efficiency and support a more structured basis for stakeholder dialogue. Its usefulness depends on the quality and availability of the underlying information, and expert facilitation remains necessary to ensure relevance and correctness.

Download as Skill

You can find more information about **skills** in general here: Skills.



Prompt Template

Copy, paste and configure the variables below.

You can find more information about **prompting** in general here: Prompting

```
## Role

You are an expert in requirements engineering and
group facilitation, supporting a requirements engineer
who plans a requirements workshop with stakeholders of
the given system.

## Goal

Create a **Workshop Plan** consisting of:
```

Pitfalls & Tips

Read on for some useful tips on how to use GenAI appropriately, and avoid the following pitfalls.

Idealized planning ignoring real-world constraints

Risk: AI-generated workshop plans reflect

```
* The **workshop frame**: duration, start and end time, setting, number of participants, and the **decision rule** for conflicts.
* **Workshop goals** (`WG {{n}}`): goal and expected result.
* **Participants** (`WP {{n}}`), including the facilitator and a scribe: role, number of persons, and expected contribution.
* **Preparation tasks** (`PT {{n}}`): task and timing; plus a list of **materials**.
* **Agenda items** (`AGD {{n}}`), in chronological order: start time, duration in minutes, title, technique, activity, and the workshop goals served, as ids.
* **Facilitation tips** (`FT {{n}}`): situation and recommended action.
* **Follow-up steps** (`FS {{n}}`): step and timing.

## Instructions

1. **Use the documents**: Take the participants and the scope of the agenda from any documents the user provides, such as a stakeholder list or the requirements to be worked on.
2. **Mark assumptions**: Mark every value the user did not give as assumed or estimated, and explain an estimated duration in one sentence. If the duration is too short for the goals, reduce the scope and say so.
3. **Plan the time**: Include breaks and a buffer, make the durations add up exactly to the workshop duration, and serve every workshop goal with at least one agenda item. Check the times before returning the result.
4. **Close the loop**: Cover at least conflicts, dominant participants, and silent participants in the facilitation tips, resolve conflicts according to the decision rule, and include validating the results with the participants in the follow-up.
5. **Choose techniques** that let every participant contribute, and explain them at their first use.

## Input

Ask the user for the system, the participants, and the workshop goals, and optionally the duration, the setting, and any documents before proceeding.

---

## Output

{{output_format}}
```

Configuration

Set the configuration options as described below.

`{{output_format}}`

E.g.,

- `Markdown table.`
- `Return JSON only.`

Using a **reasoning model** is recommended.

textbook best practices assuming ideal conditions - full stakeholder availability, clear roles, no conflict. Real-world constraints such as limited time, competing priorities, or inexperienced facilitators are ignored.

Mitigation: Have plans reviewed by experienced requirements engineers and facilitators for practical feasibility. Explicitly budget time buffers and escalation paths.

Ignoring interpersonal stakeholder dynamics

Risk: AI cannot anticipate power imbalances, political tensions, or personal conflicts between stakeholders that often influence workshop outcomes more than methodology choices.

Mitigation: Conduct pre-workshop stakeholder interviews and address interpersonal risks manually in the facilitation plan.

API Usage

For an API call, treat the prompt above as system prompt and use the separate user prompt below instead of the `## Input` section of the system prompt:

```
## Input
The system is provided below between <SYSTEM> tags.

<SYSTEM>
{{system}}
</SYSTEM>

The participants, with their roles and the number of persons per role, are provided below between <PARTICIPANTS> tags.

<PARTICIPANTS>
{{participants}}
</PARTICIPANTS>

The workshop goals are provided below between <GOALS> tags.

<GOALS>
{{goals}}
</GOALS>

The duration and start time are provided below between <DURATION> tags; they may be empty.

<DURATION>
{{duration}}
</DURATION>

The setting (on-site, remote, or hybrid) is provided below between <SETTING> tags.

<SETTING>
{{setting}}
</SETTING>
```

Example

In this example the Input

Generated with ChatGTP 5.5.

Role

You are an expert in requirements engineering and group facilitation, supporting me as a requirements engineer who plans a requirements workshop with stakeholders of the given system.

Goal

Create a Workshop Plan consisting of:

- Workshop Goals (WG n): goal, expected result.

⚠ **Over-reliance on structured methods at the expense of adaptability**

Risk: AI tends to over-weight predefined techniques (e.g. brainstorming, MoSCoW) and under-emphasize the importance of adapting flexibly to group energy, resistance, and emerging topics.

Mitigation: Explicitly brief facilitators on their flexibility to deviate. Treat suggested methods as a starting point, not a rigid script.

⚠ **Underestimating post-workshop effort**

Risk: AI-generated plans mention post-workshop steps (documentation, validation) only briefly, underestimating the significant effort required to convert workshop output into traceable, prioritized requirements.

Mitigation: Explicitly plan the post-workshop

- Participants (WP n): role, number, expected contribution.
- Preparation Tasks (PT n): task, timing; plus a list of materials.
- Agenda Items (AGD n), in chronological order: start time, duration in minutes, title, technique, activity, workshop goals as ids.
- Facilitation Tips (FT n): situation, recommended action.
- Follow-up Steps (FS n): step, timing.

Instructions

1. If no duration is given, estimate it from the goals, the group size, and the setting, and explain the estimate.
2. Choose techniques that suit each goal, the group size, and the setting, and that let every participant contribute.
3. Start with an opening and end with a summary. Plan breaks and a buffer, and make the durations add up exactly to the workshop duration.
4. Cover at least conflicts, dominant participants, and silent participants in the facilitation tips.
5. Include documenting the results and validating them with the participants in the follow-up.

Output

One Markdown document with a table per list.

Input

Ask the user for the input documents before proceeding.

Please upload or paste the input documents describing the system and its requirements. I'll use them to develop a tailored requirements workshop plan for you as the requirements engineer.

Useful documents include:

- System description: purpose, scope, functionality, architecture, and boundaries.
- Requirements documents: existing requirements, specifications, user stories, or use cases.

phase with a realistic time budget.

For **general pitfalls** that apply across all tasks, also see: General Pitfalls

- Stakeholder information: stakeholder roles, interests, responsibilities, and known conflicts.
- Project context: objectives, constraints, open questions, risks, and decisions that need to be made.

If available, please also share the following workshop details:

- Workshop duration: e.g., 2 hours, half a day, or a full day.
- Participants: expected number and roles.
- Setting: in-person, remote, or hybrid.
- Priority topics: e.g., requirements elicitation, prioritization, resolving conflicts, or validating existing requirements.

You can provide only the documents initially; I'll work with the available information and identify any assumptions or missing details.

Once I have the input, I'll create one structured Markdown document containing all six requested tables:

1. Workshop Goals (WG)
2. Participants (WP)
3. Preparation Tasks and Materials (PT)
4. Chronological Agenda (AGD), including techniques, activities, breaks, and buffer time
5. Facilitation Tips (FT), including conflicts, dominant participants, and silent participants
6. Follow-up Steps (FS), including documentation and validation with participants

I'll also explain the estimated workshop duration if you haven't specified one and ensure that the agenda durations add up exactly to the total workshop time.

1. Aviation Safety
2. Aeronautical Information Services (AIS)
3. future users of the system 10
4. in-person
5. Understand user roles, tasks, and pain points, Elicit new requirements from end-users

Requirements Workshop Plan: Aviation Safety & Aeronautical Information Services (AIS)

Format: In-person · Participants: 10 future users · Planned duration: 4 hours · Focus: User understanding and requirements elicitation

1. Workshop Goals (WG)

ID	Goal	Expected result
WG1	Understand user roles, responsibilities, and operational context.	A shared map of user roles, responsibilities, information needs, and dependencies.
WG2	Understand users' tasks, workflows, and pain points.	Current-state workflow maps identifying tasks, handovers, bottlenecks, errors, and unmet needs.
WG3	Elicit new requirements from end-users.	A structured list of candidate functional and non-functional requirements linked to user needs and operational scenarios.
WG4	Establish a shared understanding of the findings.	A consolidated summary of user needs, candidate requirements, assumptions, and open questions.

2. Participants (WP)

The workshop assumes that all 10 participants are future users. The facilitator and note-taker are additional support roles where possible.

ID	Role	Number	Expected contribution
WP1	Future AIS users	4	Describe aeronautical information tasks, information flows, data needs, and challenges.
WP2	Future aviation safety users	4	Describe safety-related tasks, operational constraints, time-critical information needs, and pain points.
WP3	Cross-functional future users	2	Explain cross-role dependencies, information handovers, shared tasks, and coordination challenges.
WP4	Requirements engineer / facilitator	1	Guide discussions, elicit requirements, ensure

			balanced participation, and manage time.
WP5	Scribe / requirements analyst	1	Record user needs, workflow details, candidate requirements, assumptions, and open questions.

Participant composition is provisional. If the 10 users do not divide naturally into these groups, assign participants based on their actual roles and tasks.

3. Preparation Tasks (PT)

ID	Task	Timing
PT1	Clarify the system's purpose, boundaries, and known aviation safety and AIS use cases.	5 business days before
PT2	Identify the participants' anticipated roles and operational experience.	5 business days before
PT3	Prepare a short glossary of relevant AIS and	3 business days before

	aviation safety terms.	
PT4	Prepare workflow-mapping templates and questions about current tasks, information needs, and pain points.	3 business days before
PT5	Send participants the agenda and ask them to bring examples of difficult tasks, recurring problems, and unmet information needs.	2 business days before
PT6	Prepare requirements-capture sheets and a board for assumptions and unanswered questions.	1 business day before
PT7	Arrange the room in two groups of five, with wall space for workflow maps and sticky notes.	On the day

Materials

- System context or project overview, if available.
- Participant role descriptions, if available.

- AIS and aviation safety terminology glossary.
- Flip charts, sticky notes, markers, and adhesive dots.
- Workflow and user-role mapping templates.
- Requirements elicitation templates.
- Projector or whiteboard.
- Parking-lot board for questions that cannot be resolved during the workshop.
- Camera or other approved method for capturing workshop artefacts.

4. Agenda Items (AGD)

Duration estimate: Four hours is a reasonable starting point for 10 participants and two focused goals. It provides time for individual reflection, collaborative work in two groups, cross-group discussion, and initial requirement formulation. It assumes that participants are familiar with their own operational tasks and that no extensive system demonstration is required.

The agenda totals exactly 240 minutes, including one short break and a closing buffer.

ID	Start time	Duration (min)	Title	Technique	Activity	Workshop goals
AGD1	09:00	15	Opening and introductions	Round-robin	Introduce participants, clarify the workshop purpose, establish ground rules, and	WG1, WG4

					explain expected outputs.	
AGD2	09:15	20	Roles and operational context	Individual brainstorming and role mapping	Each participant identifies their responsibilities, key information needs, interactions, and dependencies. Consolidate the results on a shared role map.	WG1
AGD3	09:35	40	Tasks and workflows	Workflow mapping in two group	Map typical tasks from beginning	WG1, WG2

				s of five	to end, including inputs, outputs, handovers, decisions, and exceptions.	
AGD4	10:15	15	Break	Rest	Short break.	—
AGD5	10:30	35	Pain points and unmet needs	Silent brainstorming and affinity mapping	Participants independently note problems, delays, errors, information gaps, workarounds, and their operational consequences.	WG2

					Cluster related observations.	
AGD6	11:05	25	Cross-group findings	Gallery walk and facilitated discussion	Groups review each other's workflow maps, identify shared problems and differences, and add missing perspectives.	WG1, WG2
AGD7	11:30	35	Elicit new requirements	Brainwriting and structured requirement	Translate pain points into candidate requir	WG3

				formulation	ements. Capture the user need, intended outcome, source, and relevant scenario for each requirement.	
AGD8	12:05	20	Clarify and consolidate requirements	Affinity clustering and playback	Merge duplicates, clarify ambiguous statements, distinguish needs from proposed solutions, and identify	WG3, WG4

					assumptions or unanswered questions.	
AGD9	12:25	15	Buffer and closing summary	Facilitated playback and round-robin	Summarize roles, workflows, pain points, and candidate requirements. Capture missing points, confirm the next steps, and close.	WG4

Timing check

Time category	Minutes
Workshop activities	225
Break	15
Total duration	240 minutes (4 hours)

The session runs from 09:00 to 13:00.

5. Facilitation Tips (FT)

ID	Situation	Recommended action
FT1	One participant dominates the discussion.	Use silent brainstorming first, then give each participant equal time to contribute. Invite additional perspectives before opening the discussion.
FT2	Participants are reluctant to speak.	Start with individual writing or pair discussions before plenary sharing. Ask about concrete examples of tasks rather than abstract opinions.
FT3	Participants disagree about how a task should work.	Map the different workflows separately, identify contextual differences, and record unresolved disagreements without forcing premature consensus.

FT4	Participants describe solutions instead of problems.	Ask what problem the proposed solution addresses, who experiences it, and what outcome is needed. Capture the solution idea separately.
FT5	Participants use different terminology.	Maintain a shared glossary and ask participants to explain unfamiliar terms with operational examples.
FT6	Participants struggle to formulate requirements.	Use prompts such as “The user needs to…”, “The system shall…”, and “This is necessary because…”. Refine the wording after the underlying need is clear.
FT7	Discussion drifts into detailed technical design.	Redirect attention to roles, tasks, information needs, and expected outcomes. Record technical ideas for later analysis.
FT8	The group identifies more	Capture all issues, cluster

	issues than can be discussed.	similar ones, and use the available time to explore representative examples. Record remaining topics for follow-up.
FT9	Safety-related concerns arise.	Record the scenario, possible consequence, affected users, and required expert clarification. Do not treat workshop discussion as formal safety assurance.
FT10	Participants agree too quickly on a shared view.	Ask each participant to review the consolidated results independently and identify missing tasks, exceptions, or minority perspectives.

6. Follow-up Steps (FS)

ID	Step	Timing
FS1	Photograph or digitize the role maps, workflow diagrams, sticky	Same day

	notes, and workshop artefacts.	
FS2	Consolidate the role descriptions, workflows, pain points, and unmet needs into a structured workshop record.	Within 2 business days
FS3	Convert the captured needs into uniquely identified candidate requirements, preserving their sources and rationale.	Within 3 business days
FS4	Review requirements for clarity, consistency, duplicates, and testability; flag assumptions and missing information.	Within 5 business days
FS5	Send the workshop record and candidate requirements to participants for review and correction.	Within 5 business days
FS6	Incorporate feedback, document	Within 7 business days

	unresolved questions, and arrange follow-up discussions with relevant users or domain experts.	
FS7	Prepare the consolidated candidate requirements for the next requirements engineering activity, such as validation or prioritization.	Within 10 business days

7. Expected Deliverables

At the end of the workshop, you should have:

- A user-role map describing responsibilities and interactions.
- Two or more current-state workflow maps covering representative operational tasks.
- A structured list of pain points and unmet user needs.
- A set of candidate functional and non-functional requirements, linked to their originating user needs.
- A list of assumptions, open questions, and topics requiring domain expertise.
- A documented summary ready for participant review.

Facilitation recommendation: For aviation safety and AIS, focus the elicitation on real operational scenarios: what information a user needs, when it is needed, what decisions depend on it, what happens when information is missing or delayed, and how errors or exceptions are handled. This produces more actionable requirements than collecting feature ideas alone.